



cloud computing for non-profit organisations and made the argument for a 'balanced regulatory environment'. This will take into consideration both the privacy and access aspects of the cloud.

Microsoft is also following the same approach with start-ups. They are being offered

free software and services for three years via the company's BizSpark programme. However, the effort is partially aimed at converting start-ups into paid customers as they become larger companies. The new programme for non-profits, though, is more in the realm of philanthropy.

Open source start-ups can get funding from UNICEF



UNICEF has asked technology start-ups that are developing solutions to improve the lives of the world's most vulnerable children to apply for funding via its innovation fund. According to Christopher Fabian, UNICEF Innovation co-lead, "We'll be identifying opportunities

from countries around the world, including some that may not see a lot of capital investment in technology start-ups. We are hoping to identify communities of problem-solvers and help them develop simple solutions to some of the most pressing problems facing children."

In order to be eligible for the funding, the projects should be open sourced and come with a working prototype. The projects may imply development of a new technology, or expansion and improvement of an existing one.

The Innovation Fund by UNICEF has generated US\$9 million till now. It provides innovators in developing countries a pooled funding mechanism to assist them in taking their tested projects to the next level. The fund is focused on the following three portfolio areas:

- Products catering to youth under the age of 25, addressing a variety of needs which include learning as well as youth participation
- Real-time information for decision-making
- Infrastructure for increasing access to services and information, which includes connectivity, power, finance, sensors and transport

Applications are going to be assessed based on a range of criteria. These will include the strength of the team, the project's relevance to children, and the ability of seeing potential future value in the open source intellectual property being created.

The upcoming KDE Neon Project

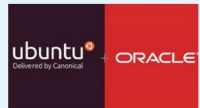
The KDE Neon Project was announced by ex-Kubuntu maintainer, Jonathan

Oracle partners with Canonical

Canonical has joined hands with Oracle to offer enterprises a flexible option in developing and deploying large-scale workloads on Oracle Cloud. The partnership was announced through an Ubuntu Insights blog post and is now available on the Oracle Cloud Marketplace offering Oracle enterprise customers with new options for managing and scaling workloads.

Canonical maintains, tests and updates certified Ubuntu images and also makes its latest versions available on the Oracle Cloud Marketplace within minutes of its official release by Canonical. For Ubuntu LTS versions, Canonical offers maintenance and security updates for five years.

Apart from the cost savings of open source cloud development, the main advantage of using official Ubuntu images is that customers use the same operating system at scale in production as in development, with no extra cost. This, in turn, simplifies cross-substrate management, migration and re-engineering, as per Udi Nachmany, head of the certified public cloud division at Canonical.



The partnership is a move by Oracle to broaden the range of options for Oracle enterprise customers. It gives them a lot more options and flexibility while selecting cloud technologies, as stated by Sanjay Sinha, vice president, platform products, at Oracle.